48 Gal · Galatians

1 Paul, an apostle—sent not from men nor by man, but by Jesus Christ and
God the Father, who raised Him from the dead— [2] and all the brothers with
me, To the churches of Galatia: [3] Grace and peace to you from God our Father
and the Lord Jesus Christ, [4] who gave Himself for our sins to rescue us from
the present evil age, according to the will of our God and Father, [5] to whom be
glory forever and ever. Amen. [6] I am amazed how quickly you are deserting the
One who called you by the grace of Christ and are turning to a different gospel—
[7] which is not even a gospel. Evidently some people are troubling you and trying
to distort the gospel of Christ.

[8] But even if we or an angel from heaven should preach a gospel contrary to
the one we preached to you, let him be under a curse! [9] As we have said before,
so now I say again: If anyone is preaching to you a gospel contrary to the one
you received, let him be under a curse! [10] Am I now seeking the approval of men,
or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I
would not be a servant of Christ. [11] For I certify to you, brothers, that the gospel
I preached was not devised by man. [12] I did not receive it from any man, nor was
I taught it; rather, I received it by revelation from Jesus Christ. [13] For you have
heard of my former way of life in Judaism, how severely I persecuted the church
of God and tried to destroy it. [14] I was advancing in Judaism beyond many of
my contemporaries and was extremely zealous for the traditions of my fathers.
[15] But when God, who set me apart from my mother's womb and called me by
His grace, was pleased

[16] to reveal His Son in me so that I might preach Him among the Gentiles, I
did not rush to consult with flesh and blood, [17] nor did I go up to Jerusalem
to the apostles who came before me, but I went into Arabia and later returned
to Damascus.

[18] Only after three years did I go up to Jerusalem to confer with Cephas, and I
stayed with him fifteen days. [19] But I saw none of the other apostles except James,
the Lord's brother. [20] I assure you before God that what I am writing to you
is no lie. [21] Later I went to the regions of Syria and Cilicia. [22] I was personally
unknown, however, to the churches of Judea that are in Christ. [23] They only
heard the account: "The man who formerly persecuted us is now preaching the
faith he once tried to destroy." [24] And they glorified God because of me.

2 Fourteen years later I went up again to Jerusalem, accompanied by Barnabas.
I took Titus along also. [2] I went in response to a revelation and set before them
the gospel that I preach among the Gentiles. But I spoke privately to those
recognized as leaders, for fear that I was running or had already run in vain. [3] Yet
not even Titus, who was with me, was compelled to be circumcised, even though
he was a Greek. [4] This issue arose because some false brothers had come in under
false pretenses to spy on our freedom in Christ Jesus, in order to enslave us. [5] We
did not give in to them for a moment, so that the truth of the gospel would
remain with you. [6] But as for the highly esteemed—whatever they were makes no
difference to me; God does not show favoritism—those leaders added nothing
to me.

[7] On the contrary, they saw that I had been entrusted to preach the gospel
to the uncircumcised, just as Peter had been to the circumcised. [8] For the One
who was at work in Peter's apostleship to the circumcised was also at work in my
apostleship to the Gentiles. [9] And recognizing the grace that I had been given,
James, Cephas, and John—those reputed to be pillars—gave me and Barnabas
the right hand of fellowship, so that we should go to the Gentiles, and they to
the circumcised.

[10] They only asked us to remember the poor, the very thing I was eager to do.
[11] When Cephas came to Antioch, however, I opposed him to his face, because he
stood to be condemned. [12] For before certain men came from James, he used to
eat with the Gentiles. But when they arrived, he began to draw back and separate
himself, for fear of those in the circumcision group. [13] The other Jews joined him
in his hypocrisy, so that by their hypocrisy even Barnabas was led astray.

[14] When I saw that they were not walking in line with the truth of the gospel, I
said to Cephas in front of them all, "If you, who are a Jew, live like a Gentile and
not like a Jew, how can you compel the Gentiles to live like Jews?" [15] We who
are Jews by birth and not Gentile "sinners" [16] know that a man is not justified by
works of the law, but by faith in Jesus Christ. So we, too, have believed in Christ
Jesus, that we may be justified by faith in Christ and not by works of the law,
because by works of the law no one will be justified. [17] But if, while we seek to be
justified in Christ, we ourselves are found to be sinners, does that make Christ
a minister of sin? Certainly not! [18] If I rebuild what I have already torn down, I
prove myself to be a lawbreaker. [19] For through the law I died to the law so that I
might live to God. [20] I have been crucified with Christ, and I no longer live, but
Christ lives in me. The life I live in the body, I live by faith in the Son of God,
who loved me and gave Himself up for me. [21] I do not set aside the grace of God.
For if righteousness comes through the law, Christ died for nothing.

3 O foolish Galatians! Who has bewitched you? Before your very eyes Jesus
Christ was clearly portrayed as crucified. [2] I would like to learn just one thing
from you: Did you receive the Spirit by works of the law, or by hearing with faith?
[3] Are you so foolish? After starting in the Spirit, are you now finishing in
the flesh? [4] Have you suffered so much for nothing, if it really was for nothing?
[5] Does God lavish His Spirit on you and work miracles among you because you
practice the law, or because you hear and believe? [6] So also, "Abraham believed
God, and it was credited to him as righteousness." [7] Understand, then, that those
who have faith are sons of Abraham. [8] The Scripture foresaw that God would
justify the Gentiles by faith, and foretold the gospel to Abraham: "All nations
will be blessed through you."

[9] So those who have faith are blessed along with Abraham, the man of faith.
[10] All who rely on works of the law are under a curse. For it is written: "Cursed
is everyone who does not continue to do everything written in the Book of
the Law." [11] Now it is clear that no one is justified before God by the law, because,
"The righteous will live by faith." [12] The law, however, is not based on faith; on
the contrary, "The man who does these things will live by them."

[13] Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us.
For it is written: "Cursed is everyone who is hung on a tree." [14] He redeemed
us in order that the blessing promised to Abraham would come to the Gentiles
in Christ Jesus, so that by faith we might receive the promise of the Spirit.
[15] Brothers, let me put this in human terms. Even a human covenant, once
it is ratified, cannot be canceled or amended. [16] The promises were spoken to
Abraham and to his seed. The Scripture does not say, "and to seeds," meaning
many, but "and to your seed," meaning One, who is Christ. [17] What I mean is
this: The law that came 430 years later does not revoke the covenant previously
established by God, so as to nullify the promise. [18] For if the inheritance depends
on the law, then it no longer depends on a promise; but God freely granted it to
Abraham through a promise.

[19] Why then was the law given? It was added because of transgressions, until the
arrival of the seed to whom the promise referred. It was administered through
angels by a mediator. [20] A mediator is unnecessary, however, for only one party;
but God is one. [21] Is the law, then, opposed to the promises of God? Certainly
not! For if a law had been given that could impart life, then righteousness would
certainly have come from the law. [22] But the Scripture pronounces all things
confined by sin, so that by faith in Jesus Christ the promise might be given to
those who believe. [23] Before this faith came, we were held in custody under the
law, locked up until faith should be revealed. [24] So the law became our guardian
to lead us to Christ, that we might be justified by faith. [25] Now that faith has
come, we are no longer under a guardian. [26] You are all sons of God through
faith in Christ Jesus. [27] For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed
yourselves with Christ. [28] There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor
female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus. [29] And if you belong to Christ, then
you are Abraham's seed and heirs according to the promise.

4 What I am saying is that as long as the heir is a child, he is no different from
a slave, although he is the owner of everything. [2] He is subject to guardians and
trustees until the date set by his father. [3] So also, when we were children, we were
enslaved under the basic principles of the world. [4] But when the time had fully
come, God sent His Son, born of a woman, born under the law, [5] to redeem those
under the law, that we might receive our adoption as sons. [6] And because you are
sons, God sent the Spirit of His Son into our hearts, crying out, "Abba, Father!"
[7] So you are no longer a slave, but a son; and since you are a son, you are also an
heir through God. [8] Formerly, when you did not know God, you were slaves to
those who by nature are not gods. [9] But now that you know God, or rather are
known by God, how is it that you are turning back to those weak and worthless
principles? Do you wish to be enslaved by them all over again?

[10] You are observing special days and months and seasons and years! [11] I fear
for you, that my efforts for you may have been in vain. [12] I beg you, brothers,
become like me, for I became like you. You have done me no wrong. [13] You know
that it was because of an illness that I first preached the gospel to you. [14] And
although my illness was a trial to you, you did not despise or reject me. Instead,
you welcomed me as if I were an angel of God, as if I were Christ Jesus Himself.

[15] What then has become of your blessing? For I can testify that, if it were
possible, you would have torn out your eyes and given them to me. [16] Have I now
become your enemy by telling you the truth? [17] Those people are zealous for you,
but not in a good way. Instead, they want to isolate you from us, so that you may
be zealous for them. [18] Nevertheless, it is good to be zealous if it serves a noble
purpose—at any time, and not only when I am with you. [19] My children, for
whom I am again in the pains of childbirth until Christ is formed in you, [20] how
I wish I could be with you now and change my tone, because I am perplexed
about you. [21] Tell me, you who want to be under the law, do you not understand
what the law says? [22] For it is written that Abraham had two sons, one by the
slave woman and the other by the free woman. [23] His son by the slave woman
was born according to the flesh, but his son by the free woman was born through
the promise. [24] These things serve as illustrations, for the women represent two
covenants. One covenant is from Mount Sinai and bears children into slavery:
This is Hagar. [25] Now Hagar stands for Mount Sinai in Arabia and corresponds
to the present-day Jerusalem, because she is in slavery with her children. [26] But
the Jerusalem above is free, and she is our mother. [27] For it is written: "Rejoice, O
barren woman, who bears no children; break forth and cry aloud, you who have

never travailed; because more are the children of the desolate woman than of her who has a husband." [28] Now you, brothers, like Isaac, are children of promise. [29] At that time, however, the son born by the flesh persecuted the son born by the Spirit. It is the same now. [30] But what does the Scripture say? "Expel the slave woman and her son, for the slave woman's son will never share in the inheritance with the free woman's son." [31] Therefore, brothers, we are not children of the slave woman, but of the free woman.

5 It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not be encumbered once more by a yoke of slavery. [2] Take notice: I, Paul, tell you that if you let yourselves be circumcised, Christ will be of no value to you at all. [3] Again I testify to every man who gets himself circumcised that he is obligated to obey the whole law. [4] You who are trying to be justified by the law have been severed from Christ; you have fallen away from grace. [5] But by faith we eagerly await through the Spirit the hope of righteousness. [6] For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision nor uncircumcision has any value. All that matters is faith, expressed through love. [7] You were running so well. Who has obstructed you from obeying the truth?

[8] Such persuasion does not come from the One who calls you. [9] A little leaven works through the whole batch of dough. [10] I am confident in the Lord that you will take no other view. The one who is troubling you will bear the judgment, whoever he may be. [11] Now, brothers, if I am still preaching circumcision, why am I still being persecuted? In that case the offense of the cross has been abolished. [12] As for those who are agitating you, I wish they would proceed to emasculate themselves! [13] For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love. [14] The entire law is fulfilled in a single decree: "Love your neighbor as yourself." [15] But if you keep on biting and devouring one another, watch out, or you will be consumed by one another. [16] So I say, walk by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the flesh.

[17] For the flesh craves what is contrary to the Spirit, and the Spirit what is contrary to the flesh. They are opposed to each other, so that you do not do what you want. [18] But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law. [19] The acts of the flesh are obvious: sexual immorality, impurity, and debauchery; [20] idolatry and sorcery; hatred, discord, jealousy, and rage; rivalries, divisions, factions, [21] and envy; drunkenness, orgies, and the like. I warn you, as I did before, that those who practice such things will not inherit the kingdom of God.

[22] But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, [23] gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law. [24] Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires. [25] Since we live by the Spirit, let us walk in step with the Spirit. [26] Let us not become conceited, provoking and envying one another.

6 Brothers, if someone is caught in a trespass, you who are spiritual should restore him with a spirit of gentleness. But watch yourself, or you also may be tempted. [2] Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ. [3] If anyone thinks he is something when he is nothing, he deceives himself. [4] Each one should test his own work. Then he will have reason to boast in himself alone, and not in someone else. [5] For each one should carry his own load. [6] Nevertheless, the one who receives instruction in the word must share in all good things with his instructor. [7] Do not be deceived: God is not to be mocked. Whatever a man sows, he will reap in return. [8] The one who sows to please his flesh, from the flesh will reap destruction; but the one who sows to please the Spirit, from the Spirit will reap eternal life. [9] Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.

[10] Therefore, as we have opportunity, let us do good to everyone, and especially to the family of faith. [11] See what large letters I am using to write to you with my own hand! [12] Those who want to make a good impression outwardly are trying to compel you to be circumcised. They only do this to avoid persecution for the cross of Christ. [13] For the circumcised do not even keep the law themselves, yet they want you to be circumcised that they may boast in your flesh. [14] But as for me, may I never boast, except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, through which the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world. [15] For neither circumcision nor uncircumcision means anything. What counts is a new creation. [16] Peace and mercy to all who walk by this rule, even to the Israel of God. [17] From now on let no one cause me trouble, for I bear on my body the marks of Jesus. [18] The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit, brothers. Amen.

49 Eph · Ephesians

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, To the saints in Ephesus, the faithful in Christ Jesus: [2] Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ. [3] Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed us in Christ with every spiritual blessing in the heavenly realms. [4] For He chose us in Him before the foundation of the world to be holy and blameless in His presence. In love [5] He predestined us for adoption as His sons through Jesus Christ, according to the good pleasure of His will, [6] to the praise of His glorious grace, which He has freely given us in the Beloved One.

[7] In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses, according to the riches of His grace [8] that He lavished on us with all wisdom and understanding. [9] And He has made known to us the mystery of His will according to His good pleasure, which He purposed in Christ [10] as a plan for the fullness of time, to bring all things in heaven and on earth together in Christ. [11] In Him we were also chosen as God's own, having been predestined according to the plan of Him who works out everything by the counsel of His will, [12] in order that we, who were the first to hope in Christ, would be for the praise of His glory.

[13] And in Him, having heard and believed the word of truth—the gospel of your salvation—you were sealed with the promised Holy Spirit, [14] who is the pledge of our inheritance until the redemption of those who are God's possession, to the praise of His glory.

[15] For this reason, ever since I heard about your faith in the Lord Jesus and your love for all the saints, [16] I have not stopped giving thanks for you, remembering you in my prayers, [17] that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the glorious Father, may give you a spirit of wisdom and revelation in your knowledge of Him. [18] I ask that the eyes of your heart may be enlightened, so that you may know the hope of His calling, the riches of His glorious inheritance in the saints, [19] and the surpassing greatness of His power to us who believe. These are in accordance with the working of His mighty strength, [20] which He exerted in Christ when He raised Him from the dead and seated Him at His right hand in the heavenly realms, [21] far above all rule and authority, power and dominion, and every name that is named, not only in the present age but also in the one to come. [22] And God put everything under His feet and made Him head over everything for the church, [23] which is His body, the fullness of Him who fills all in all.

2 And you were dead in your trespasses and sins, [2] in which you used to walk when you conformed to the ways of this world and of the ruler of the power of the air, the spirit who is now at work in the sons of disobedience. [3] All of us also lived among them at one time, fulfilling the cravings of our flesh and indulging its desires and thoughts. Like the rest, we were by nature children of wrath. [4] But because of His great love for us, God, who is rich in mercy, [5] made us alive with Christ even when we were dead in our trespasses. It is by grace you have been saved! [6] And God raised us up with Christ and seated us with Him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus, [7] in order that in the coming ages He might display the surpassing riches of His grace, demonstrated by His kindness to us in Christ Jesus. [8] For it is by grace you have been saved through faith, and this not from yourselves; it is the gift of God, [9] not by works, so that no one can boast.

[10] For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life. [11] Therefore remember that formerly you who are Gentiles in the flesh and called uncircumcised by the so-called circumcision (that done in the body by human hands)— [12] remember that at that time you were separate from Christ, alienated from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers to the covenants of the promise, without hope and without God in the world. [13] But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far away have been brought near through the blood of Christ.

[14] For He Himself is our peace, who has made the two one and has torn down the dividing wall of hostility [15] by abolishing in His flesh the law of commandments and decrees. He did this to create in Himself one new man out of the two, thus making peace [16] and reconciling both of them to God in one body through the cross, by which He extinguished their hostility. [17] He came and preached peace to you who were far away and peace to those who were near. [18] For through Him we both have access to the Father by one Spirit. [19] Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God's household, [20] built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Christ Jesus Himself as the cornerstone. [21] In Him the whole building is fitted together and grows into a holy temple in the Lord. [22] And in Him you too are being built together into a dwelling place for God in His Spirit.

3 For this reason I, Paul, the prisoner of Christ Jesus for the sake of you Gentiles... [2] Surely you have heard about the stewardship of God's grace that was given to me for you, [3] that is, the mystery made known to me by revelation, as I have already written briefly. [4] In reading this, then, you will be able to understand my insight into the mystery of Christ, [5] which was not made known to men in other generations as it has now been revealed by the Spirit to God's holy apostles and prophets. [6] This mystery is that through the gospel the Gentiles are fellow heirs, fellow members of the body, and fellow partakers of the promise in Christ Jesus.

[7] I became a servant of this gospel by the gift of God's grace, given me through the working of His power. [8] Though I am less than the least of all the saints, this grace was given me: to preach to the Gentiles the unsearchable riches of Christ, [9] and to illuminate for everyone the stewardship of this mystery, which for ages past was kept hidden in God, who created all things.

[10] His purpose was that now, through the church, the manifold wisdom of God should be made known to the rulers and authorities in the heavenly realms, [11] according to the eternal purpose that He accomplished in Christ Jesus

our Lord. [12] In Him and through faith in Him we may enter God's presence with boldness and confidence. [13] So I ask you not to be discouraged because of my sufferings for you, which are your glory.

[14] … for this reason I bow my knees before the Father, [15] from whom every family in heaven and on earth derives its name. [16] I ask that out of the riches of His glory He may strengthen you with power through His Spirit in your inner being, [17] so that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. Then you, being rooted and grounded in love, [18] will have power, together with all the saints, to comprehend the length and width and height and depth [19] of the love of Christ, and to know this love that surpasses knowledge, that you may be filled with all the fullness of God. [20] Now to Him who is able to do immeasurably more than all we ask or imagine, according to His power that is at work within us, [21] to Him be the glory in the church and in Christ Jesus throughout all generations, forever and ever. Amen.

4 As a prisoner in the Lord, then, I urge you to walk in a manner worthy of the calling you have received: [2] with all humility and gentleness, with patience, bearing with one another in love, [3] and with diligence to preserve the unity of the Spirit through the bond of peace. [4] There is one body and one Spirit, just as you were called to one hope when you were called; [5] one Lord, one faith, one baptism; [6] one God and Father of all, who is over all and through all and in all. [7] Now to each one of us grace has been given according to the measure of the gift of Christ. [8] This is why it says: "When He ascended on high, He led captives away, and gave gifts to men." [9] What does "He ascended" mean, except that He also descended to the lower parts of the earth?

[10] He who descended is the very One who ascended above all the heavens, in order to fill all things. [11] And it was He who gave some to be apostles, some to be prophets, some to be evangelists, and some to be pastors and teachers, [12] to equip the saints for works of ministry and to build up the body of Christ, [13] until we all reach unity in the faith and in the knowledge of the Son of God, as we mature to the full measure of the stature of Christ. [14] Then we will no longer be infants, tossed about by the waves and carried around by every wind of teaching and by the clever cunning of men in their deceitful scheming. [15] Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head. [16] From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part.

[17] So I tell you this, and insist on it in the Lord, that you must no longer walk as the Gentiles do, in the futility of their thinking. [18] They are darkened in their understanding and alienated from the life of God because of the ignorance that is in them due to the hardness of their hearts. [19] Having lost all sense of shame, they have given themselves over to sensuality for the practice of every kind of impurity, with a craving for more. [20] But this is not the way you came to know Christ.

[21] Surely you heard of Him and were taught in Him—in keeping with the truth that is in Jesus— [22] to put off your former way of life, your old self, which is being corrupted by its deceitful desires; [23] to be renewed in the spirit of your minds; [24] and to put on the new self, created to be like God in true righteousness and holiness.

[25] Therefore each of you must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to his neighbor, for we are all members of one another. [26] "Be angry, yet do not sin." Do not let the sun set upon your anger, [27] and do not give the devil a foothold. [28] He who has been stealing must steal no longer, but must work, doing good with his own hands, that he may have something to share with the one in need. [29] Let no unwholesome talk come out of your mouths, but only what is helpful for building up the one in need and bringing grace to those who listen. [30] And do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God, in whom you were sealed for the day of redemption. [31] Get rid of all bitterness, rage and anger, outcry and slander, along with every form of malice. [32] Be kind and tenderhearted to one another, forgiving each other just as in Christ God forgave you.

5 Be imitators of God, therefore, as beloved children, [2] and walk in love, just as Christ loved us and gave Himself up for us as a fragrant sacrificial offering to God. [3] But among you, as is proper among the saints, there must not be even a hint of sexual immorality, or of any kind of impurity, or of greed. [4] Nor should there be obscenity, foolish talk, or crude joking, which are out of character, but rather thanksgiving. [5] For of this you can be sure: No immoral, impure, or greedy person (that is, an idolater), has any inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and of God. [6] Let no one deceive you with empty words, for because of such things the wrath of God is coming on the sons of disobedience. [7] Therefore do not be partakers with them. [8] For you were once darkness, but now you are light in the Lord. Walk as children of light, [9] for the fruit of the light consists in all goodness, righteousness, and truth. [10] Test and prove what pleases the Lord.

[11] Have no fellowship with the fruitless deeds of darkness, but rather expose them. [12] For it is shameful even to mention what the disobedient do in secret. [13] But everything exposed by the light becomes visible, for everything that is illuminated becomes a light itself. [14] So it is said: "Wake up, O sleeper, rise up from the dead, and Christ will shine on you." [15] Pay careful attention, then, to how you walk, not as unwise but as wise, [16] redeeming the time, because the days are evil. [17] Therefore do not be foolish, but understand what the Lord's will is. [18] Do not get drunk on wine, which leads to reckless indiscretion. Instead, be filled with the Spirit. [19] Speak to one another with psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs. Sing and make music in your hearts to the Lord, [20] always giving thanks to God the Father for everything in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. [21] Submit to one another out of reverence for Christ.

[22] Wives, submit to your husbands as to the Lord. [23] For the husband is the head of the wife as Christ is the head of the church, His body, of which He is the Savior.

[24] Now as the church submits to Christ, so also wives should submit to their husbands in everything. [25] Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave Himself up for her [26] to sanctify her, cleansing her by the washing with water through the word, [27] and to present her to Himself as a glorious church, without stain or wrinkle or any such blemish, but holy and blameless. [28] In the same way, husbands ought to love their wives as their own bodies. He who loves his wife loves himself. [29] Indeed, no one ever hated his own body, but he nourishes and cherishes it, just as Christ does the church. [30] For we are members of His body. [31] "For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh." [32] This mystery is profound, but I am speaking about Christ and the church. [33] Nevertheless, each one of you also must love his wife as he loves himself, and the wife must respect her husband.

6 Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right. [2] "Honor your father and mother" (which is the first commandment with a promise), [3] "that it may go well with you and that you may have a long life on the earth." [4] Fathers, do not provoke your children to wrath; instead, bring them up in the discipline and instruction of the Lord. [5] Slaves, obey your earthly masters with respect and fear and sincerity of heart, just as you would obey Christ. [6] And do this not only to please them while they are watching, but as servants of Christ, doing the will of God from your heart. [7] Serve with good will, as to the Lord and not to men, [8] because you know that the Lord will reward each one for whatever good he does, whether he is slave or free. [9] And masters, do the same for your slaves. Give up your use of threats, because you know that He who is both their Master and yours is in heaven, and there is no favoritism with Him. [10] Finally, be strong in the Lord and in His mighty power.

[11] Put on the full armor of God, so that you can make your stand against the devil's schemes. [12] For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this world's darkness, and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms. [13] Therefore take up the full armor of God, so that when the day of evil comes, you will be able to stand your ground, and having done everything, to stand. [14] Stand firm then, with the belt of truth buckled around your waist, with the breastplate of righteousness arrayed, [15] and with your feet fitted with the readiness of the gospel of peace.

[16] In addition to all this, take up the shield of faith, with which you can extinguish all the flaming arrows of the evil one. [17] And take the helmet of salvation and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God. [18] Pray in the Spirit at all times, with every kind of prayer and petition. To this end, stay alert with all perseverance in your prayers for all the saints. [19] Pray also for me, that whenever I open my mouth, words may be given me so that I will boldly make known the mystery of the gospel, [20] for which I am an ambassador in chains. Pray that I may proclaim it fearlessly, as I should. [21] Tychicus, the beloved brother and faithful servant in the Lord, will tell you everything, so that you also may know about me and what I am doing. [22] I have sent him to you for this very purpose, that you may know about us, and that he may encourage your hearts. [23] Peace to the brothers and love with faith from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ. [24] Grace to all who love our Lord Jesus Christ with an undying love.